

CORE ARBINGER PRINCIPLES

1. There are two “Ways of Being”—the Responsive way where we see others as people, and the Resistant way where we see others as objects.

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2. Way of Being is deeper and more important than behavior.

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3. When we betray ourselves, we enter the Resistant way of being (the “box”).

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4. In the Resistant way of being, we see others and ourselves in ways that justify our own self-betrays.

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5. Over a lifetime of self-betrayal, we develop characteristic self-justifying ways of seeing ourselves and the world; we carry our “boxes” with us.

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6. From within the box, we can exhibit many different outward styles of self-betrayal, but all of them are fundamentally accusing.

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7. Therefore, in the box, we provoke others to get in the box as well, and the mistreatment we then get from others gives us justification for staying in the box.

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8. We get out of the box not by focusing on ourselves but by responding to others—that is, by receiving the humanity of those we have been resisting.

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9. Responsive relationships and memories give us leverage to get out of the box in other areas of our lives. We get out of the box by finding an out-of-the-box place within us and then pondering the situation anew from that perspective.

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10. Once out of the box, we *stay* out of the box by doing for others what we feel we need to do.

